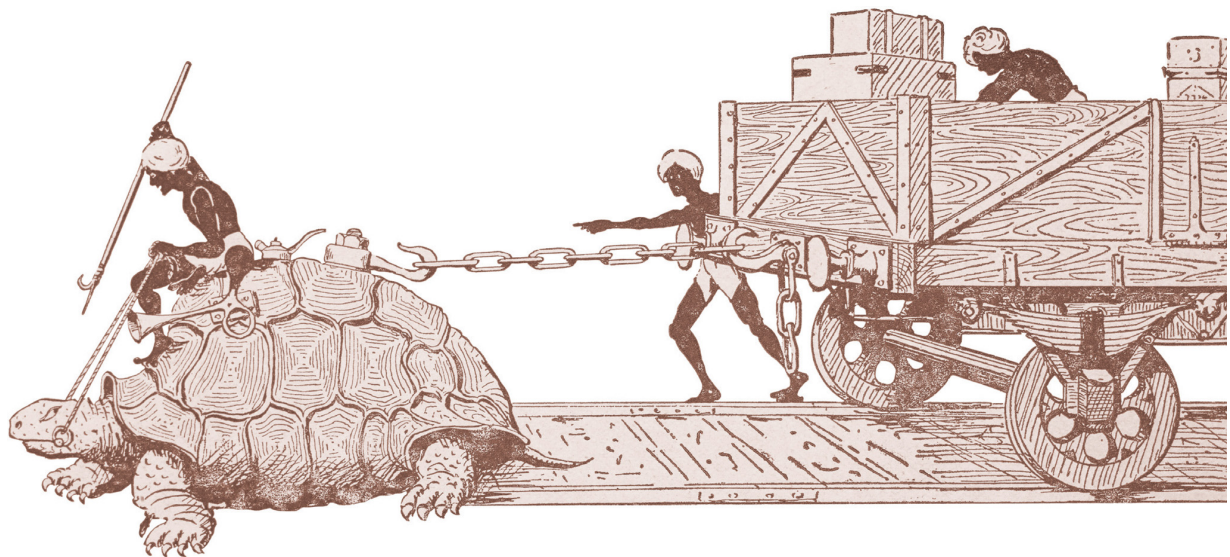


otherwise, some insights into the sociocultural set up, or at least the British perception of it. These are reflected in some recurring motifs, such as those of Ganesha (the elephant god), men wearing loincloths, and structures with domes, among others.

The work can also be seen as a part of the larger discourse that projects railways as a colonial endeavour to the British and Indian audience. In this context of representation, the choice of railways as a subject of study has its own foundations. Since railways is often equated with progress and development, and has a huge material presence, it served as the most registered and obvious symbol for British advancement in the colonies.

The booklet carried a glossary with translations of Hindustani to English words. It is likely that the author anticipated a British audience. If he was writing only for English-speaking Indians, he wouldn't have felt the need to provide English translations of anglicized local terms at the end of his work. Moreover, Thacker, Spink & Co had a distribution channel in London and it is likely that the work would have reached the shores of Great Britain.



▲ Titled **"New Shunting Power"**, the giant turtle pictured here is what the author perceived to be a "substitute" for shunting engines.